

Nikita Kazeev

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Research Scientist at the intersection of AI and Physics

WORK EXPERIENCE

PERFOMAX <i>AI Advisor</i>	2026–present
CONSTRUCTOR GROUP <i>Machine Learning Consultant</i>	2021–present
NATIONAL UNIVERSITY OF SINGAPORE <i>Postdoc under Kostya Novoselov</i>	2022–present

Leadership

- Program Chair for the [AI4X 2025/6 conferences](#)
- Main organiser of the [ICLR 2025 Workshop on Machine Learning Multiscale Processes](#)
- Co-PI of a US\$3.4m AI Singapore grant on multiscale machine learning

Wyckoff Transformer, a generative model for materials [ICML 2025](#) · [GitHub](#)

- Developed a coordinate-free permutation-invariant autoregressive Transformer encoder model for material generation and property prediction based on symmetry inductive bias
- Increased materials discovery yield (S.U.N.) by 1.24x
- Cut inference to 0.05 GPU-ms/structure — 4 orders of magnitude faster than prior models
- Implemented the model in PyTorch; production-ready package published on [PyPI](#)
- Orchestrated large-scale (10k structures) DFT computations with VASP on an HPC cluster
- Led a team of 6

ML for defects in 2D crystals [npj 2D Mater. Appl.](#) · [npj Comput. Mater.](#) · [patent](#) · [GitHub](#)

- Conceived a novel sparse representation of crystals with defects
- Cut energy-prediction error 3.7x vs. the best prior model
- Optimised training and inference: 4x less memory, 8x fewer GPU operations
- Built a reproducible pipeline for parallel ML experiments
- Led a team of 3

(CERN | YANDEX → HSE UNIVERSITY) *Researcher* 2014–2022
[2025 Breakthrough Prize in Fundamental Physics](#) as a member of LHCb.

Muon identification at the LHCb experiment at CERN [paper](#) · [poster](#) · [IDAO-2019](#)

- Solved a classification problem over tabular data with noisy labels under timing constraints
- Built a CatBoost model that cut the false-positive rate 30% in the critical low-momentum region
- Shipped the model into the LHCb trigger (C++ & Python)
- Packaged the work as a data science competition problem for IDAO-2019

CatBoost aka fighting biases with dynamic boosting [paper](#)

- Built the team's distributed experiment infrastructure (Bash/Python)
- Studied gradient boosting improvements with experiments on toy data

EDUCATION

HSE University & Sapienza Università di Roma <i>PhD in Computer Science and Physics (Double Degree)</i> Supervisors: Andrey Ustyuzhanin & Barbara Sciascia Thesis: Machine Learning for particle identification in the LHCb detector	2016–2020
Product Management course at Yandex <i>Focused coursework in product strategy and execution.</i>	2018
Yandex School of Data Analysis <i>Master's-level CS programme</i> Algorithms, machine learning, deep learning, and distributed systems.	2013–2015
Moscow Institute of Physics and Technology <i>MS in Physics</i> Optimisation of data processing of the LHCb experiment.	2014–2016
<i>BS in Physics</i> Wave-packet molecular dynamics of electrons in nonideal plasma.	2010–2014
International Junior Science Olympiad (IJSO) Silver medal	Korea, 2008

MENTORSHIP

- Mentored 9 students ([1](#), [2](#), [3](#), [4](#), [5](#), [6](#), [7](#), [8](#), [9](#)), 3 interns, and student workshop projects ([1](#), [2](#)).

TEACHING & OUTREACH

- Pitch research to the general public through major newspaper coverage ([1](#), [2](#)), blog posts ([1](#), [2](#)), a [science slam](#), interviews ([1](#), [2](#)), and a public [talk](#).
- Taught at the Machine Learning in High Energy Physics Summer School in [2015](#), [2016](#), [2017](#), [2018](#), [2019](#), [2020](#), [2021](#), and [2023](#).
- Lecturer in the [award-winning](#) Coursera Advanced Machine Learning [specialisation](#)
- Taught and developed an introductory data analysis [course](#) at HSE.
- Delivered more than 20 [conference talks](#).

SERVICE

- Reviewer for NeurIPS, RSC Advances, Machine Learning: Science and Technology, Digital Discovery
- Peer Staff Supporter at NUS, serving as a first-line support for mental wellbeing.

SKILLS

- **ML on structured, non-text data** — tabular, graph, and atomistic representations, spanning gradient boosting to transformers.
- **Inference and systems at scale** — C++ production integration, large-scale DFT/VASP on HPC clusters, and reproducible experiment pipelines.
- **Research leadership** — lead multidisciplinary teams, chair conferences, and mentor students from idea to publication.

ML & AI • Python • PyTorch • C++ • HPC • Research Writing & Speaking • Leadership & Mentorship

PRESENTING AT ICML 2026

July 11, 15:00–16:30 — Nikita Kazeev and Phan Bui Nhat Huyen. [“Position: Align AI to Our Aspirations, Not Our Flaws”](#). In: *Pluralistic Alignment Workshop at ICML 2026*.

July 11, 10:50–11:50 & 15:55–16:55 — Artem Dembitskiy*, Shuya Yamazaki*, Artem Maevskiy*, **Nikita Kazeev***, Roman A. Eremin, Semen Budenny, Kedar Hippalgaonkar, Antonio Helio Castro Neto, and Andrey E. Ustyuzhanin. [“Generative Pipeline for Discovering Solid-State Battery Materials with Universal Atomistic Potentials”](#). In: *AI for Science Workshop at ICML 2026*. *Equal Contribution.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Nikita Kazeev, Wei Nong, Ignat Romanov, Ruiming Zhu, Andrey E Ustyuzhanin, Shuya Yamazaki, and Kedar Hippalgaonkar. [“Wyckoff Transformer: Generation of Symmetric Crystals”](#). In: *Proceedings of the 42nd International Conference on Machine Learning*. Ed. by Aarti Singh, Maryam Fazel, Daniel Hsu, Simon Lacoste-Julien, Felix Berkenkamp, Tegan Maharaj, Kiri Wagstaff, and Jerry Zhu. Vol. 267. Proceedings of Machine Learning Research. PMLR, 13–19 Jul 2025, pp. 29495–29526.

Nikita Kazeev, A. R. Al-Maeeni, I. Romanov, et al. [“Sparse representation for machine learning the properties of defects in 2D materials”](#). In: *npj Computational Materials* 9 (2023), p. 113.